
Strategic Recommendations

Restoration Roofing SC — Digital Presence

Detail	Information
From	Jimmy Davidson, Solutions Developer, Agentic Personnel Solutions
To	Tom Davis
Date	April 2026
Re	How your buyer actually finds roofers in 2026

This report was compiled using a range of strategic LLM tools, including Perplexity, Claude, ChatGPT, and Qwen 3.5.

Quick Read

Your website is built on a modern, AI-ready stack and ready to go live. The technical foundation for all four search layers — traditional SEO, AEO, GEO, and AIO — is already in place, including **73 pre-rendered pages**, **21 city pages with full location schema**, **server-rendered structured data site-wide**, **Roofle RoofQuote PRO integration**, and a **mobile-first build**.

That means the conversation with JD Plumbing is not *can this site support SEO?* It already does, and more. The conversation is about extending a foundation that is already compounding.

This document lays out your buyer, what she is doing, what the site already delivers, what is left to finish, and how the work should be divided between JD Plumbing and APS going forward.

Your Customer: She's Doing the Research

Before any conversation about search engines, SEO, or AI, it is worth grounding in who is actually making the hiring decision. Industry surveys often misrepresent this, and most marketing plans are built for the wrong person.

Key buyer signals

- Women account for **85% of all consumer purchases** and influence **91% of home-related purchase decisions** (*Nielsen / Federal Reserve research; Kleber & Associates*).
- Women make **65% of all home remodeling decisions** and purchase more than **50% of products historically marketed to men**, including home-improvement products (*Kleber & Associates; Roofing Contractor Magazine*).
- Millennials, now aged 30–45, lead all generations in home renovation activity, with **78%** working on upgrades in the past year (*LendingTree 2025; Bank of America Millennial Home Improvement Survey*).
- The sweet-spot buyer is a woman aged **35–44**, the highest-earning bracket of any generation, with a median household income around **\$132,700** (*Fortune / NAR 2026*).
- Millennials are **82% more likely** to buy fixer-uppers than new builds, meaning they are actively hiring contractors on older homes (*Bank of America*).

What she values when choosing a roofer

- **Trust and credibility** — professional presentation, real photos of the team, and clear credentials.
- **Reviews from real customers** — she reads them carefully, not just the star count.
- **Transparent pricing** — **78%** of homeowners are more likely to call if pricing is visible on the website (*RC 2025 Survey*).
- **Responsive communication** — companies responding within one minute see up to a **391% improvement in lead conversion** (*Roofing Revenue Marketing*).

The practical profile of your primary buyer is a woman aged 35–55, living in a home 25+ years old, researching on her phone, influenced heavily by what her neighbors and online reviews say, and increasingly willing to trust an AI answer when it recommends a business. Marketing that does not reach her is marketing that misses the decision.

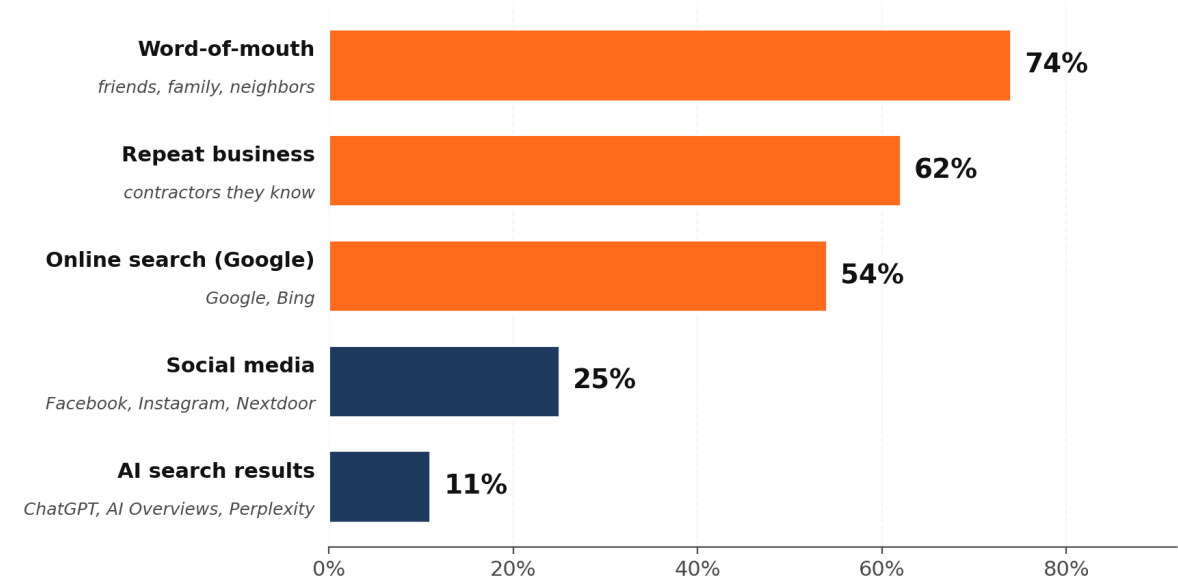
How That Buyer Actually Finds a Roofer (2026 Data)

The 2026 *Roofing Contractor Homeowner Survey* — fielded nationwide with Roofle Technologies and Owens Corning as research partners — is the most authoritative source on this question.

Important context on how to read these numbers: this was a multi-select survey. Respondents were asked, *How do you find roofing contractors?* and could select every method they use, not just one. That is why the percentages total well over 100%. The average homeowner uses **2–3 methods** to cross-check her decision before she calls anyone.

How Homeowners Find Roofing Companies

Multi-select: respondents chose all methods they use. Average homeowner uses 2-3.



Source: Roofing Contractor 2026 Homeowner Survey

Figure: Homeowner discovery channels, showing that referrals, repeat business, and Google still dominate while AI search has already entered the mix.

How Homeowners Find Roofing Contractors	%	Source
Word-of-mouth recommendations (friends, family, neighbors)	74%	RC 2026 Homeowner Survey
Repeat business with contractors they know	62%	RC 2026 Homeowner Survey
Online search engines (Google)	54%	RC 2026 Homeowner Survey
Social media (Facebook, Instagram, Nextdoor)	25%	RC 2026 Homeowner Survey
AI search results (ChatGPT, Google AI Overviews, Perplexity)	11%	RC 2026 Homeowner Survey

What this actually looks like in practice

A 42-year-old homeowner in Charleston needs a new roof. She asks her neighbors and her sister-in-law for recommendations. She remembers the guy who fixed her gutter two years ago and considers calling him. She also Googles *best roofers in Charleston* to see who else is out there. Then she scrolls Facebook community groups to see if anyone posted about a roofer recently.

That one person is counted in four of the rows above. She is not picking a channel. She is cross-referencing across four of them.

Strategic implication: being visible on Google alone is not enough. Being present everywhere she checks — and consistent across all of it — is how you win the call.

The critical insight about word-of-mouth

Word-of-mouth is still number one, but it no longer stands alone. Referrals do not replace online research; they trigger it. A neighbor says, *we used ABC Roofing*; the homeowner immediately Googles *ABC Roofing reviews*, reads them, checks the website, and then calls. That means even referral customers are judging your online presence before they ever pick up the phone.

Where the generational split matters

The younger your target buyer, the more she leans on search and social to find contractors.

Finding Method	Millennials	Gen X	Boomers
Social media	40%	27%	15%

Source: RC 2025 Homeowner Survey, breakdown by generation.

Your primary buyer — millennials and younger Gen X — is the most digitally dependent generation in roofing history. A large portion of the 74% word-of-mouth number, for her, is Google reviews and Facebook/Nextdoor recommendations, not conversations over the fence.

The Homeowner’s Journey: From Problem to Phone Call

Understanding the journey matters because it explains why multi-channel visibility wins.

- The typical journey takes **72 hours or less** from problem to first phone call (*PM Magazine*).
- Homeowners average **5.5 interactions** with a company — website visit, reading reviews, clicking an ad — before they contact anyone.
- **85%** of homeowners only contact **3 or fewer companies**. If you are not in their top-three shortlist, you do not get considered.

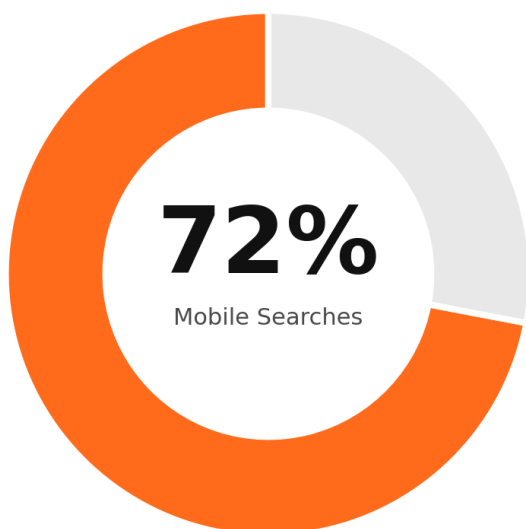
- Emergency roof searches peak from **6 PM to midnight**, when most roofing offices are closed (*Hook Agency*).

Strategic implication: companies that capture leads after hours — through a chatbot, instant-quote tool like Roofle, online scheduling, or a fast-response SMS system — win the high-intent customers that competitors miss overnight. The site's giraffe-mascot AI chat widget and Roofle integration are already built for exactly this.

What She Does on Her Phone

Roofing is now a mobile-first purchase. The data is unambiguous.

Where Homeowners Search for a Roofer



72% Mobile

Phones in pockets, backyards, driveways

28% Desktop & Tablet

Office, home computer

78%

of mobile roofing searches lead to a purchase within 24 hours

Sources: Invoca, SearchScaleAI 2026

Figure: Roofing search behavior is overwhelmingly mobile, which makes speed, clarity, and mobile UX central to conversion.

- **72%** of roofing searches happen on mobile, not desktop (*Invoca*).
- **90%** of traffic to local business listings comes from mobile (*FranceNum*).
- **76%** of *near me* searches result in a related business visit within 24 hours (*Google*).
- **46%** of all Google searches have local intent (*LocalIQ / Whitespark*).

- *Open now near me* searches have grown **400%+** in recent years (*Google data via Guest Suite*).
- The top three listings in Google’s Map Pack capture **44–58%** of all clicks for local searches (*SearchScaleAI 2026*).
- **60–90%** of roofing leads originate from the Google Map Pack (*Blue Aspen Marketing*).

What makes her call one roofer vs. another

Decision Factor	Data Point	Source
Online reviews rated very/extremely important	67% of homeowners	RC 2025 Survey
Homeowners more likely to call if pricing is on the website	78%	RC Homeowner Survey
Homeowners who hire the first company that appears trustworthy	40%	Industry research 2026
Revenue uplift per 1-star Google rating improvement (4.0 → 5.0)	~45%	Harvard Business School research
Homeowners who avoid companies rated below 4 stars	87%	BrightLocal 2026
Homeowners who only trust reviews from the last 3 months	74%	BrightLocal 2026
Roofers who still do not show any pricing online	33%	RC Homeowner Survey

The short version: she is on her phone, scanning reviews, looking for pricing, and prepared to call the first company that looks credible. **40% of the decision is made before anyone ever picks up the phone.**

Google Reviews: The Numbers That Matter

Reviews are no longer a nice-to-have. They directly determine whether you show up in Google search results, whether AI tools recommend you, and whether homeowners call you.

Milestone	What It Gets You
20+ reviews	Minimum credibility — 47% of homeowners will not use a company with fewer (<i>BrightLocal 2026</i>)

Milestone	What It Gets You
4.0+ stars	Non-negotiable — 87% of homeowners avoid companies below 4 stars (<i>BrightLocal 2026</i>)
79+ reviews	Median review count for companies ranking in Google's top 3 Map Pack (<i>Local Falcon via UENI</i>)
4.5+ stars	The expectation for 31% of homeowners; also the threshold for AI recommendations
340+ reviews	Where AI chatbots like ChatGPT consistently include a local business in recommendations (<i>Digital Footprint Solutions</i>)

One critical fact: **74% of homeowners only trust reviews from the last three months** (*BrightLocal 2026*). A company with 200 old reviews is less credible than a company with 50 fresh ones. Review velocity — getting new reviews consistently every month — matters as much as total count.

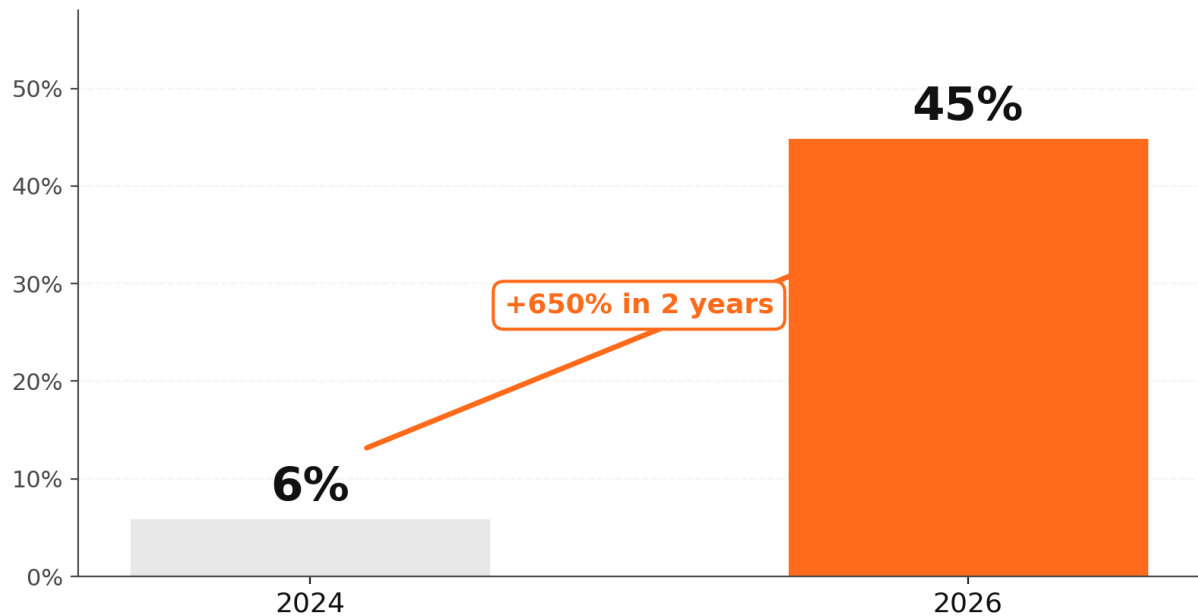
Target per location: 8–10 new Google reviews per month, with at least an 80% response rate.

What AI Is Adding to This Picture

AI search is the biggest shift in a decade for how homeowners find contractors. It converts at dramatically higher rates than Google, and the companies being cited in AI answers today are establishing durable advantages.

AI Adoption for Finding Local Businesses

Share of consumers who have used AI tools (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI) to find local service providers



Source: BrightLocal 2026 Local Consumer Review Survey

Figure: Consumer use of AI for local-business discovery has accelerated dramatically in just two years, which is why early visibility matters now.

- AI adoption for finding local businesses went from **6% in 2024** to **45% in 2026** — a **650% increase** in two years (*BrightLocal 2026*).
- **11%** of homeowners cite AI search as a primary method specifically for finding roofing contractors, and that number doubled from 2025 (*RC Homeowner Survey*).
- **One in three** homeowners under 45 has already used AI to find a home-service provider in the last 90 days (*Digital Footprint Solutions*).
- AI Overviews now appear in roughly **50%** of Google searches, so traditional Google users increasingly see AI-generated recommendations before the blue links (*Advanced Web Ranking, Dec 2024*).
- **40%** of sources cited in Google AI Overviews rank beyond position 10 in traditional Google. AI surfaces different sources than traditional SEO optimizes for (*Exposure Ninja 2026*).
- AI search traffic converts at **14.2%** versus Google's **2.8%**, roughly **5x higher** (*Discovered Labs / Exposure Ninja 2026*).
- Google still owns roughly **80%** of all digital queries. AI is an additive channel, not a replacement (*StatCounter March 2026; First Page Sage Q1 2026*).

Why AI referrals are worth more than Google clicks

When someone asks ChatGPT, *who is the best roofer in Charleston?* and it names your company, that recommendation carries the weight of a trusted referral. The homeowner has already decided to trust you before visiting your website. That is why conversion rates are 5x higher.

The next shift: AI is already calling contractors

Google has begun testing a feature where its AI calls roofing companies directly to check pricing and availability, then displays price comparisons to homeowners in search results. Companies without transparent pricing on their website get skipped entirely (*Forward First Media*). This is the future: AI systems acting as middlemen between homeowners and contractors. Your website needs to be readable by both humans and AI agents, which is exactly what we built it to be.

The honest read is that Google is still the primary channel, and that is not changing anytime soon. But AI is **11%** of roofing-buyer discovery today, growing fast, and the buyers arriving through AI close at **5x the rate** of everyone else. The companies getting recommended by AI in 2026 are establishing advantages their competitors will struggle to displace.

Where to Spend: Channel Comparison

Not all lead sources are created equal. Some channels give you cheap leads that never close. Others cost more up front but produce customers who sign contracts. Know the trade-offs.

Channel	Cost per Lead	Close Rate	Best For
SEO (after 12 months)	\$5–\$25	35–45%	Long-term, compounding. Lowest cost once established.
Google Local Service Ads	\$25–\$75	30–40%	Immediate leads with Google’s Guaranteed badge. Highest-ROI paid channel.
Referrals	Free	40–60%	Best close rate. Limited by volume.
Nextdoor (organic)	Free	35–52%	Neighbors recommending you. Extremely high trust.
Facebook Ads	\$20–\$85	15–25%	Reach and brand awareness. Lower intent than Google.

Channel	Cost per Lead	Close Rate	Best For
Google Search Ads (PPC)	\$80–\$256	25–35%	Immediate visibility. Expensive. Cost is climbing every year.
Lead Marketplaces (Angi, etc.)	\$75–\$200	8–15%	Shared leads with competitors. Lowest close rate.

Sources: SearchLight Digital Q1 2026; Pipeline On; Built-Right Digital; BaaDigi.

The sweet spot is Google Local Service Ads for immediate lead flow, plus SEO investment for long-term compounding returns. Over 12–18 months, SEO becomes the lowest-cost, highest-volume lead channel, but it takes time to build.

What's Built and Ready to Go Live

Let me cut to the point on this section, because it matters for every decision you make downstream.

Over the past several weeks I have put a significant amount of work into this site that goes well beyond what a typical roofing website gets. The technical foundation for all four search layers — traditional SEO, AEO, GEO, and AIO — is built into the bones of the site itself. That is not a metaphor. On the chart below, the green sections are already complete: **82% of traditional SEO**, **65% of AEO**, **72% of GEO**, and **55% of AIO**.

Those numbers do not exist by accident. They exist because the site was built on a forward-thinking, AI-ready stack from day one, specifically because I could see where search was headed in 2026. Most roofing sites are plugin-patched WordPress builds that have to bolt these features on after the fact, if they bolt them on at all. RR-SC has them as native architecture.

Why this matters for the tech stack decision: if the site is rebuilt on a different platform, every one of those green bars resets toward zero. The 82% SEO completeness, the 65% AEO, the 72% GEO, and the 55% AIO would all need to be rebuilt from scratch on whatever platform replaces this one, and most traditional SEO stacks — WordPress, Wix, Squarespace — are architecturally incapable of hitting the same numbers without heavy custom development. That is the piece I want to make sure gets weighed honestly before anyone green-lights a platform switch.

The four search layers — and where each one stands

Layer	What it does	Status
SEO	Traditional Google / Bing rankings	~82% complete — server-side rendering on every page; full metadata system with unique titles and descriptions on all 73 routes; automatic image optimization (WebP conversion, responsive sizing, lazy loading); self-hosted font optimization for zero layout shift; clean URL structure with no query strings; automatic internal linking matrix cross-referencing services and locations; sitemap at <code>/sitemap.xml</code> ; mobile-first responsive design with 44px tap targets; Core Web Vitals optimized with priority LCP images.
AEO	Featured snippets, “People Also Ask,” voice answers	~65% complete — server-rendered JSON-LD on homepage, service pages, and all 21 locations; FAQPage and BreadcrumbList schema in place; semantic HTML5 with proper heading hierarchy; blog infrastructure built with 9 posts drafted; context-aware internal linking reinforcing topical authority.
GEO	Local SEO, Google Maps, “near me” searches	~72% complete — site-wide geo meta tags pinning Mount Pleasant, SC; 21 dedicated city pages, each with full RoofingContractor + GeoCoordinates + areaServed + openingHoursSpecification + OfferCatalog schema; automatic service ↔ location cross-linking; all 21 cities declared in <code>areaServed</code> on every service page; NAP consistency on-site.

Layer	What it does	Status
AIO	AI assistant citation (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, Gemini, Google AI Overviews)	~55% complete — fully SSR HTML on all 73 pages, so when DNS cuts over AI crawlers receive complete content rather than a JavaScript shell; rich entity graph via per-page JSON-LD; on-site AI chat widget with a 13,000-word knowledge base; <code>robots.txt</code> allowing all major AI bots.

What the percentages really say is that every one of these layers is further along than most live roofing-contractor websites in the country, before the site has even gone to production. The work the SEO marketing team is about to do on this platform has a massive head start compared with what they would be working with on a typical WordPress build.

Concretely — what’s built and ready

- **73 pages pre-rendered at build time, served as cached HTML from Vercel’s global edge network.** Every page loads instantly for customers, and every search engine and AI crawler gets a complete, ready-to-read page.
- **21 dedicated city pages with server-rendered RoofingContractor + Place + GeoCoordinates + BreadcrumbList + OfferCatalog schema, each uniquely localized.** Each service city has its own dedicated page telling Google exactly what you do there. This is what wins the Map Pack.
- **11+ service pages with Service + FAQPage + BreadcrumbList schema, with FAQ sections auto-generated from structured data.** Each service has a question-and-answer section Google and AI tools can pull from directly when a customer asks a question.
- **Homepage carrying full RoofingContractor schema with AggregateRating, GeoCoordinates, City, and OpeningHours.** Your homepage tells Google and AI tools what you are, where you are, how you are rated, and when you are open, in the language they specifically read.
- **Site-wide geo meta tags pinning Mount Pleasant, SC (32.8468, -79.8203) into every page.** Every page tells Google Maps that the business is physically in Mount Pleasant, SC, a local-ranking signal most competitors do not have.
- **Physical address in every schema: 1261 Pearwood Ct, Mount Pleasant, SC 29464.** Address consistency is one of the strongest Map Pack ranking factors, and it is embedded at the code level rather than just placed in a footer.
- **Roofle RoofQuote PRO slideout integrated site-wide.** Customers can get an instant roof quote from any page. This directly addresses the 78% pricing-transparency behavior and gives AI tools a differentiator they can cite.

- **On-site AI chat widget (giraffe mascot) running OpenAI gpt-4o-mini with a 13,000-word knowledge base.** This provides 24/7 lead qualification. When a customer lands at 11 PM, they get real answers instead of a contact form and silence.
- **Mobile-first overhaul complete (April 18, 2026)** — 44px tap targets, `svh` viewport units, `next/image` migration of 19 images, and `prefers-reduced-motion` support. The site is built phone-first, not just made to also work on phones.
- **Tech stack:** Next.js 16.2 (App Router), React 19.2, TypeScript 5, Tailwind CSS 4, Supabase (PostgreSQL), and Vercel Fluid Compute. These are foundational choices made for speed, search performance, scalability, and avoiding rebuild cycles every 2–3 years.

What the RR-SC site already does that most roofing competitors do not

Most roofing contractors in the Charleston / Mount Pleasant market are running WordPress or Wix with client-side JavaScript rendering, no JSON-LD, no location-specific schema, and generic meta descriptions. That means when a GPT-4-class crawler or Google AI Overview hits their pages, it gets an empty JavaScript shell. Once the RR-SC site goes live, crawlers will receive complete rendered content and structured data on every page. That is not a marginal advantage; it is the difference between being citable and being invisible.

Verify For Yourself

Do not take my word for any of this. Copy the block below, paste it into any LLM you trust — ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity, or Grok — along with any question you have about SEO, AEO, GEO, AIO, mobile performance, scalability, local search, or anything else. You will get an independent read on every claim in this document.

=== RESTORATION ROOFING SC – WEBSITE TECH STACK (April 2026) ===

Framework: Next.js 16.2 (App Router)

UI library: React 19.2

Language: TypeScript 5

Hosting: Vercel (Fluid Compute, global edge CDN)

Runtime: Node.js 24 LTS

Styling: Tailwind CSS 4 + Radix UI primitives + Framer Motion

Fonts: DM Sans + Playfair Display (self-hosted via next/font)

Database: Supabase (PostgreSQL)

Forms: React Hook Form + Zod validation

Analytics: Google Analytics 4

AI chat widget: OpenAI gpt-4o-mini + 13,000-word knowledge base

Quote tool: Roofle RoofQuote PRO (slideout, site-wide)

Rendering: Server-side rendering (SSR) + static site generation (SSG) on all 73 pages; pre-rendered HTML at build time

Images: next/image – automatic WebP, responsive srcset, lazy loading

URLs: Clean structure, no query strings

/services/[slug], /areas-we-serve/[slug]

Sitemap: /sitemap.xml (dynamic version pending)

Robots.txt: Permissive; all major AI crawlers allowed

Mobile: Mobile-first responsive, 44px tap targets, svh viewport units

Core Web Vitals: LCP images prioritized, fonts preloaded, zero layout shift

Internal linking: Automatic service ↔ location cross-linking matrix

Structured data (JSON-LD, server-rendered):

- Homepage: RoofingContractor + AggregateRating + GeoCoordinates + City + OpeningHours
- Service pages: Service + FAQPage + BreadcrumbList
- 21 city pages: RoofingContractor + Place + GeoCoordinates + BreadcrumbList + OfferCatalog + areaServed + openingHoursSpecification
- Blog index: Blog

Geo meta tags: Site-wide – Mount Pleasant, SC (32.8468, -79.8203)

Physical address: 1261 Pearwood Ct, Mount Pleasant, SC 29464 (embedded in schema on every page)

Service area: 21 cities across coastal South Carolina

Page count: 73 pre-rendered pages at deploy

=== QUESTIONS TO ASK THE LLM ===

1. Is this tech stack well-suited for ranking on Google in 2026?
2. Is it well-suited for being cited by AI Overviews, ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, and Gemini?
3. Is it well-suited for winning local "Map Pack" and "near me" searches?
4. How does it compare to WordPress or Wix for a local service business that needs to scale across multiple acquired companies?
5. What would be lost if this site were rebuilt on a traditional WordPress or Wix stack?
6. Is the structured data coverage above-average, average, or below-average for a local service business website?

What's Still Pending — Two Buckets

Bucket 1: Technical Cleanup (~1 week with my agent team)

These are the specific items identified in the current tech-stack audit. None of them are foundational builds. They are the last 20% that closes the loop.

Traditionally, this list would be 2–3 weeks of focused work for a developer or agency. Here is where my team of AI agents pays for itself: think of it like a small digital crew of specialists, each trained for a specific job. One handles schema markup, one handles blog publishing, one handles image optimization, one handles review responses, and one handles social-post curation. I act as the foreman organizing the crew. What would be 2–3 weeks of manual work compresses into about a week, and the same crew stays on retainer to handle the ongoing work after launch.

Priority	Item	Layer
BLOCKER	Production DNS cutover to <code>restorationroofingsc.com</code>	GEO / SEO
HIGH	<code>alternates.canonical</code> URL on every page	SEO
HIGH	Convert <code>public/sitemap.xml</code> → dynamic <code>src/app/sitemap.ts</code>	SEO / AIO
HIGH	Global Organization + WebSite + SearchAction schema in root layout	AEO
HIGH	Launch the 9 drafted blog posts (biggest single AEO/AIO lever)	AEO / AIO
HIGH	Verify <code>restorationroofingsc.com</code> in Google Search Console + Bing Webmaster Tools	SEO / AIO
HIGH	Link Google Business Profile to production domain	GEO
HIGH	Add direct-answer paragraphs at the top of every service page	AIO
MED	Review + AggregateRating schema (activates once reviews are flowing)	AEO / GEO

Priority	Item	Layer
MED	Promote <code>/process</code> to standalone route with <code>HowTo</code> + <code>HowToStep[]</code> schema	AEO
MED	Canonical Fact Sheet page (licenses, insurance, founded date, service polygon)	AIO
MED	Add <code>llms.txt</code> at site root + explicit AI-crawler allow in <code>robots.txt</code>	AIO
MED	Per-city enrichment (neighborhoods, school districts, local landmarks)	GEO
MED	Call tracking (CallRail) with dynamic number insertion	SEO / GEO
LOW	IndexNow submission on blog publish	AIO
LOW	QAPage and Speakable schema on question-style pages	AEO

Bucket 2: Off-Site Engine (the heavier, compounding work)

The technical site is the foundation. The off-site citation ecosystem is where AI visibility actually compounds. This is also where most SEO teams — including JD Plumbing, based on the scope they have described — do not operate. It is what separates RR-SC from every other roofer in the Charleston market.

2a. Review velocity and automation

Per the data earlier, **79+ reviews at 4.5+ stars** wins the Map Pack. **340+ reviews** gets you into AI recommendations. Each one-star improvement correlates with roughly **45% revenue uplift**. Target: **8–10 fresh reviews per month per location**. I would build a post-job automation loop — SMS plus email request triggered within minutes of job completion, response cached to the site with Review schema markup, and syndicated to Google, Yelp, BBB, and Angi automatically.

2b. Reddit presence (highest-ROI AI citation move)

Roughly **43% of ChatGPT citations come from Reddit**. Active, authentic presence in `r/Charleston`, `r/HomeImprovement`, `r/Roofing`, and `r/Insurance` — real account, real answers, clear affiliation — can move RR-SC into AI recommendations in months. This is not spam posting. Five thoughtful comments a month can outperform a blog post that takes four hours to write.

2c. YouTube content (heavily cited, almost no local roofers doing it)

Google AI Overviews cite YouTube extensively. In the Charleston roofing market, competitor coverage is near zero. Phone-shot videos work: hail-damage walkthroughs, insurance-claim explainers, what a real roof-replacement timeline looks like, and when you should **not** call a roofer. Format matters more than production quality, because AI is reading the transcript and structured metadata, not judging cinematography.

2d. Listicle placements

Getting included in existing *best roofers in Charleston* articles that already rank is one of the single highest-ROI moves available. This is dedicated outreach, not broad link building. Target the listicles already being cited in AI answers, make a clear value pitch based on reviews, credentials, and localized proof, and get added to the list.

2e. AI citation tracking

Share-of-voice tracking across ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, Bing Copilot, and Google AI Overviews. Answers vary each time, so tracking is probabilistic. The purpose is to measure where RR-SC appears, where competitors appear instead, and which off-site tactics move the needle. This is the PR roadmap.

2f. Proprietary data content

Fresh, original data gets cited disproportionately because LLMs have nowhere else to pull it from. Examples for RR-SC: *In our last 500 Charleston-area inspections, 68% of storm-damage claims uncovered hail damage the homeowner had not noticed. Or: Average insurance supplement our team recovered in 2025: \$3,200.* Numbers like this, published on your own pages, become the citation source because they literally do not exist anywhere else.

The Tech Stack Question — Revisited with Evidence

JD Plumbing has indicated interest in rebuilding the site on a different stack. This decision is worth weighing honestly. The trade-offs changed meaningfully once the current site was built and staged.

Before weighing the two options below: if you want a neutral third-party sanity check on the technical claims in this document, scroll back up to the *Verify For Yourself* block and paste the tech stack into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or Perplexity. Ask whether the stack is well-positioned for AI search, local SEO, and scaling across multiple locations. You will get the same read from any of them. You do not have to trust me on this; the tools themselves will tell you.

Option A — Keep the Current Stack

Pros	Cons
Faster page loads and better Core Web Vitals than WordPress	Less familiar to traditional SEO agencies (learning curve)
Code-level schema implementation (not plugin-based), which is more reliable for AI extraction	Non-technical editors cannot directly edit pages without a CMS layer

Pros	Cons
Designed to scale across the next five acquisitions via template cloning	Requires developer or agent-assisted content updates
Fully supports every SEO function JD Plumbing will perform	Smaller plugin ecosystem than WordPress
Mobile-first, matching 90% of your buyer's behavior	
Built for both Google search and AI search simultaneously	

Option B — Rebuild on a Different Stack

Pros	Cons
More familiar to traditional SEO agencies	Throws away 73 pages of built schema and structured data that are ready to serve AI crawlers the moment DNS cuts over
Easier for non-technical staff to edit content directly	Restarts build time (30+ days for comparable build)
Larger plugin ecosystem	Migration risk: lost pages, broken redirects, ranking dips
	Slower page speed and weaker Core Web Vitals
	Plugin-based schema is less reliable for AI extraction
	Same platform-switch problem every 2–3 years as tech evolves
	Rebuild cost duplicated for each future acquisition
	Delays the launch and the moment authority starts accruing

My recommendation

Keep the current stack. The pros of Option A are not theoretical; they are already built into a working staging site you can inspect today. The cons of Option A are operational conveniences — who edits what, and how — and those are solved with a CMS layer or agent-assisted editing workflow. I can build that layer inside APS without touching the foundation.

The cons of Option B, by contrast, are real and expensive: lost time, lost rankings, and a rebuild cost that would repeat for each acquisition from #2 through #6.

If JD Plumbing identifies specific technical needs the stack cannot support, those can be solved case by case. I am happy to work directly with them on any integration questions.

Recommended Marketing Budget Allocation

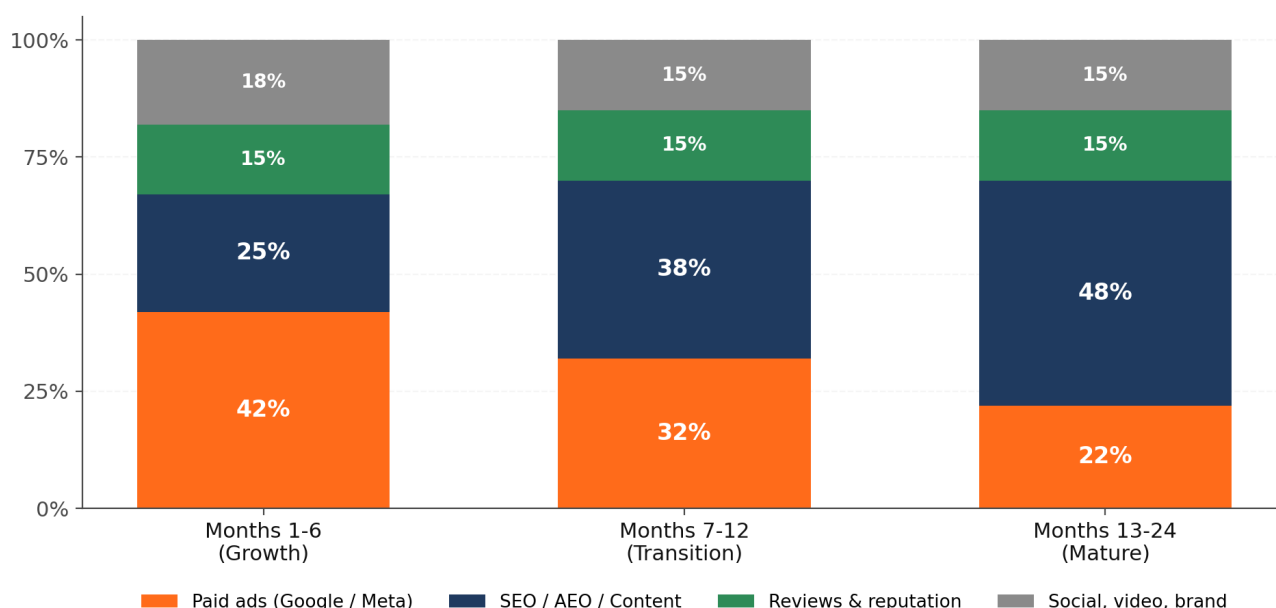
Note — Jimmy’s Extracurricular “Rabbit Hole” Research: This is an AI-generated projection. The percentages below are based on industry benchmarks and strategic modeling, not verified primary research for your specific business. They should be treated as a strategic starting point and refined with input from JD Plumbing and real performance data once campaigns are running.

The question is not how many dollars to spend; that depends on your revenue, growth stage, and competitive market. The question is how to allocate whatever total marketing budget you set. Industry benchmark for scaling roofing companies is roughly **10–12% of revenue**, with new market entries often spending **12–15%** for the first six months (*Roofing Revenue Marketing*).

Below is a strategic allocation framework, expressed entirely in percentages, for how the mix should shift as the business matures.

Marketing Budget Allocation Over Time

Percentages of total marketing spend. SEO compounds; paid declines.



AI-generated projection based on industry benchmarks. Actual allocation should be refined with SEO team input.

Figure: The recommended mix shifts away from paid acquisition over time as SEO, AEO, and content begin compounding.

How the budget shifts over time

Time Period	Allocation Direction
Months 1–6 (Growth phase)	Paid advertising carries ~ 42% of spend while SEO and AEO build momentum. Immediate visibility matters most in this phase. Review generation and content execution run in parallel.
Months 7–12 (Transition)	SEO, AEO, and structured content start producing organic leads. Paid drops to ~ 32% . Review velocity is fully ramped.
Months 13–24 (Mature)	SEO / AEO / AIO becomes the dominant lead source at ~ 48% of spend. Paid drops to ~ 22% , increasingly focused on brand and retargeting rather than cold acquisition.

The compounding advantage is simple: every dollar invested in SEO, AEO, and AIO in months 1–6 keeps producing leads in months 13–24 and beyond. Paid ads stop producing the moment you stop paying. That is why the mix shifts — not because paid stops working, but because the earned channels start working for free.

Where the Market Is Heading: 2026–2028

Note — Jimmy’s Extracurricular “Rabbit Hole” Research: These are forward-looking projections. The data points below are industry forecasts and expert projections, not current measured data. They represent a range of informed opinions about where the market may go and should be read as directional rather than guaranteed.

What is likely coming

- **AI will mediate more of customer discovery.** Forbes projects that by 2028, traditional Google search may represent less than 40% of how homeowners find contractors, down from 85% in 2024 (*Forbes Business Council 2026 — speculative projection*).
- **Voice search is already significant.** Approximately 31% of all searches are now voice-based. Voice-initiated local searches convert at **3.6x** the rate of typed searches (*Digital Applied*).
- **AI agents will book appointments.** Within 1–2 years, AI systems are expected not just to recommend contractors but to check availability, compare pricing, and schedule appointments on behalf of homeowners. Companies with online scheduling, transparent pricing, and AI-readable websites are positioned to receive those connections.

- **Contractor AI adoption is accelerating.** Industry tracking shows contractor AI adoption surged from **17% to 38% in one year** (*Roofing Contractor / ServiceTitan*). The window to be an early mover is closing.

Why this infrastructure positions you ahead

The website does not force a choice between today and tomorrow. The same server-rendered HTML, structured data, and clean schema that wins Google rankings today is what gets cited by AI chatbots, picked up by voice search, and surfaced by agentic AI systems. As RR-SC scales from one to six locations, this single platform grows with you. Each new acquisition plugs into the existing system within weeks, not months.

How JD Plumbing and APS Should Work Together

The site is built and the foundation is in place. From here forward, the work divides cleanly between two teams with complementary scopes.

Proposed division of responsibilities

Function	JD Plumbing	Jimmy / APS
Traditional Google rankings	Lead	Support
Google Business Profile	Lead	Support
Google Ads / PPC / Local Service Ads	Lead	—
Link building and local citations	Lead	Support
Content topic strategy and briefs	Lead	Support
Technical SEO (indexation, sitemaps, crawl health)	Co-lead	Co-lead (platform-level)
On-page SEO (titles, meta, headings)	Lead	Support
GA4 / Search Console reporting	Lead	—
Content execution at scale (agentic)	Input	Lead
Website platform and technical architecture	Advisory input	Lead
Schema and structured data (code-level)	Advisory input	Lead

Function	JD Plumbing	Jimmy / APS
Location page system (programmatic expansion)	Advisory input	Lead
AEO / GEO / AIO strategy	—	Lead
Reddit, YouTube, and AI-citation outreach	—	Lead
Review automation infrastructure	Input	Lead
AI citation tracking and reporting	—	Lead
Blog production (drafting, schema, publishing)	Topic briefs	Lead (execution)

The short version is that JD Plumbing runs the Google playbook on the platform we have built. APS runs the AI-search playbook and operates the platform itself. Neither team duplicates the other's work.

How the production side gets handled

On the execution side, agentic teams on my end can handle a lot of the heavy lifting — review-response workflows, social-post curation, citation monitoring, blog publishing, schema updates, and location-page buildouts — at a pace and volume most traditional agencies are not set up for. When you acquire company #2, the same workflow drops onto the new site in weeks, not months.

Next Step: Let's Sit Down Together

Rather than hand you a prescriptive 90-day plan at this stage, I think the right next move is a strategic brainstorming session — just you and me — to work through priorities, perspectives, and direction together.

The list of things that could happen in the next 90 days is long, and the sequencing matters a lot depending on where you want to put your energy and budget. A few questions worth talking through:

- Which of the pending technical items are must-haves before launch versus things we can phase in after DNS cutover?
- How aggressive do you want to get on the off-site engine — Reddit, YouTube, and listicle outreach — early, versus staying conservative until revenue starts flowing?
- What is the realistic timeline for acquisition #2, and do we pre-bake the repeatable system template now, or wait until it is closer?
- Where does JD Plumbing's scope best complement what I am doing, and where do we need tighter three-way alignment?
- What budget shape are you actually working with once revenue and operations are accounted for?

- What is your own read on the buyer data and the AI-search shift? Does any of it change how you want to spend the first six months?

I have laid out my perspective in this document. The next conversation is about yours — what you want, what your instincts say, and what you are comfortable committing to now versus phasing in over time. Once we have aligned on direction, I will put together a specific proposal with scope, timeline, and pricing we can both sign off on.

Summary

- The foundation is built and staged: **73 pre-rendered pages, 21 location pages with full schema, server-rendered JSON-LD, mobile-first build, Roofle integration, and on-site AI chat**. After a couple of UI tweaks, the site is ready to go live.
- Your buyer is a millennial or Gen X woman making a mobile-first decision, reviewing sites and reviews across **2–3 channels** before calling.
- **72 hours** is the typical window from problem to phone call, and the **top-three shortlist** is where the decision happens.
- Reviews are the non-negotiable: **79+ at 4.5+ stars** wins the Map Pack, **340+ reviews** unlocks AI recommendations, and **8–10 fresh reviews per month per location** is the target.
- AI search is **11%** of roofing discovery today and converts at **5x Google's rate**. The window to build durable citation advantages is open and closing.
- JD Plumbing owns the Google playbook. APS owns the platform, the AI-search playbook, and the agentic execution layer. Neither duplicates the other.
- Budget mix shifts from paid-heavy in months 1–6 to SEO/AEO/AIO-heavy by months 13–24 as compounding kicks in.
- Everything built for acquisition #1 becomes the repeatable template for acquisitions #2 through #6.

Happy to walk through any of this in more detail, set up the brainstorming session to align on direction, or sit down with JD Plumbing directly to coordinate scopes.

Sources

Each source below links directly to the original report or publication. Click any citation to verify.

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Jimmy Davidson

Solutions Developer

Agentic Personnel Solutions

Restoration Roofing SC — Strategic Recommendations

Reworked for improved readability and presentation; targeted Quick Read subsection removed per request.